

Issues with iPhone 4.0

Initial buyers are reporting a yellowish tinge to the display in some of the new iPhones.

No new green machines

NVIDIA announces no more flagship GPUs this year; we're stuck with the GTX 480 for now

Game peripheral test

the mouse mounted on a pedestal. There's a bunch of manuals that come in a cardboard box in individual tray-like compartments, sort of like a chest-of-drawers – premium clothes for the prince of Razer's lineup.

While its serpent-like shape and gracefully smooth contours remind you of its namesake, the Mamba also has just enough sharp angles to keep it interesting. It's designed for right-handed gamers and the grip is very comfortable for all but the largest hands. The surface has a Teflon coated finish, meant to resist sweat and enhance comfort. Both mouse buttons have gentle contours to fit fingers. The mousewheel is large and rubberised, but it's very clicky – not a bad thing. The scroll on the mouse wheel has good feedback. The two buttons on the left are perfect for use with the thumb and they're large enough to be very usable.

Advertised as wired and wireless, the Mamba ships with a Li-ion battery and a microUSB port on the mouse also accepts a neat cable. This is a plus for gamers who fear lag typically associated with wireless mice and the chance of battery losing charge. Incidentally, with the battery inserted, you can charge the mouse on the dock, or use the USB cable that charges the battery on the go. Powering it up, the Razer logo doesn't glow, but the rims of the mouse wheel light up in blue. Without the Li-ion battery the mouse is light, the 800 mAh battery is pretty thick and gives the mouse a substantial, but not over-heavy, feel. The charging dock is cool looking and uses the same detachable mouse cable and the base lights up in a cool blue. When charging the entire set up looks pretty



Razer Mamba

neat – and is worth its weight in drool value. The dpi modifying buttons are located on the top, next to the left click. The battery indicator also doubles as the dpi indicator and has a neat green/red LED colour coding for the same.

Acceleration is slower on the Titan mat owing to more grip that cloth exerts on the softer Teflon feet; on the whole, tracking on both surfaces is very good. The left/right buttons also have the right balance between travel and feedback. The feet give a lot more grip on the Destructor mat than the Logitech G9x, evidently, these were intended to be used together. In wireless mode, there is a very slight lag noticeable when quick movements are in order, and accuracy slips a notch, although if memory serves well, it's on par with the Logitech G7. For gaming though, stick with the bundled USB cable.

Although a selling point is the wireless mode, that will attract gamers on the go, the bulky dock that must be connected to a computer in order to use the mouse on it, is just too big to be carted around. This is not a portable mouse, nor was it intended to be. At Rs. 7,999 (MRP) the Mamba is one helluva gaming tool – it looks amazing, is built well and works near perfectly, but

still, for that much dough you'd go – “hmmm, can I get anything more?” The G9x with its side scroll and ratchet scroll would be better value, although the Mamba is slightly better for gamers, and a lot better looking, which is important to some people.

Logitech G9x

At first glance, without the grips, the G9x looks quite small, and although the uncomfortable-looking, angular design is surprisingly comfortable, the mouse looks suited for those with tiny hands. Two interchangeable grips in the box add handiness. These can be snap-fitted on to the mouse and giving the impression of body armour, adding bulk, (but not much weight), making the G9x a lot more comfortable. Both the grips are different, the black one, called the “Precision” grip has a matte finish that resists sweat and is much more compact with a much shallower scalloping on the left side for the thumb recess. The other grip called the “Wide Load” grip, is grey in colour, and slightly broader, with a deeper thumb recess and also adds a bit of height to the mouse with a higher top. Neither of the grips is ambidextrous (sorry lefties).

Remove the grips and the rear of the mouse has a push-in, and slide-out tray for the customisable weights. Deeper in the environment-unfriendly packaging, we found a sturdy box with weights – there are eight pieces, four each of four and seven grams. The G9x can take

up to four of these, in any combination, which means you can add a maximum of 28 grams of weight to the mouse.

Everything about the mouse breathes quality, although we found the mouse buttons to be more sensitive than the keys on the G5 and the MX518. Sans weights, the G9x feels very light, but not as weightless as the Microsoft Sidewinder. We got good results using the four-gram weights. The sensitivity button is a two-way type and located just below the left mouse key – it's accessible, but not easy to accidentally press. The sensitivity indicator is very visible. The two thumb buttons are located ergonomically and exude very good feedback. The mouse button click is a little hard, but the tilt wheel mechanism works perfectly because of this, and there are no false clicks. On the bottom of the mouse is the “micro gear” button. This toggle button allows switching between free scroll and ratchet scroll mode of the mouse wheel.

Tracking on both mousepads was very good, but on the Titan, with its cloth weave, the G9x tracks very accurately, with the right amount of grip. At a sensitivity of 2,000 dpi or so, on the Destructor, the G9x seems a little too light-handed. It is accurate for the most, but pinpoint precision takes a toss. The Mamba is (slightly) better behaved when used on the Destructor, although on the Titan, things even out between the two mice. We found both grips to be good while gaming, although the precision grip is perhaps the more accurate one for gaming, probably to the marginal reduction in centre of gravity, and the fact that due to its smaller size, you can retain a better grip on the mouse, as



Logitech G9x